Your First 90 Days Checklist

A beginner's start for UPSC CSE. Works for APPSC & TGPSC Group 1 too. Tick as you go.

Decode UPSC
with Mounika

Day 1	Day 30	Day 60	Day 90
Date:	Date:	Date:	Date:

THREE RULES BEFORE YOU START

One source per subject
Not three. Add later; never confuse yourself early.

Consistency beats hours
Full-time: ~6 focused hrs. Working: 2–3 hrs weekdays, more on weekends.

The syllabus is your boss
Keep the one-page syllabus map on your desk. Check every topic against it.

DAYS 1–30

Foundation

Understand the exam, build the reading habit, lay the NCERT base.

- [ ] Read the official CSE notification
- [ ] Print the syllabus; keep it on your desk
- [ ] Look through last year's Prelims paper
- [ ] NCERT History: Class 6–8 Social Science
- [ ] NCERT Class 12 *Themes in Indian History*
- [ ] NCERT Class 11 *Fundamentals of Physical Geography*
- [ ] NCERT Class 11 *Indian Constitution at Work*
- [ ] Newspaper, 45 min daily (The Hindu / Indian Express)

Day 30 check: syllabus read · 1 PYQ paper seen · 3+ NCERTs done · 30 days of newspaper

DAYS 31–60

One subject, deep

Master Polity end to end: Prelims, GS II and every State PSC.

- [ ] Read *Indian Polity* (M. Laxmikanth) chapter by chapter
- [ ] One page of notes per chapter, in your own words
- [ ] Solve that chapter's Prelims PYQs the same day
- [ ] Start a current-affairs notebook: one line per story + syllabus tag
- [ ] Saturday: revise the week's notes
- [ ] Sunday: weekly CA roundup; fill notebook gaps
- [ ] Newspaper, 45 min daily

Day 60 check: Polity done once · notes for every chapter · chapter-wise PYQs done

DAYS 61–90

Add & write

Start a second subject and begin answer writing.

- [ ] Choose ONE: Economy (NCERT Class 11 & 12) or Modern History
- [ ] Revise Polity a second time
- [ ] 1 Mains answer a day: 150 words, 7 minutes, by hand
- [ ] Structure: intro → points → conclusion
- [ ] Take 1 sectional Prelims test on Polity
- [ ] Analyse every wrong answer: why was it wrong?
- [ ] Newspaper, 45 min daily

Day 90 check: Polity revised twice · 2nd subject half done · 30 answers written · 1 test analysed

YOUR WEEKLY RHYTHM

Mon–Fri	Phase study + newspaper (45 min) + from Day 61, one answer
Saturday	Revise everything from this week. No new topics.
Sunday	Weekly current affairs roundup · update CA notebook · plan next week
+ Group 1	One evening a week on your state: history, culture, economy, schemes

FIVE MISTAKES TO AVOID

1. Collecting resources instead of reading them
2. Choosing your optional in week one; wait 3+ months
3. Watching videos without writing anything down
4. Comparing your Day 20 with someone's Year 2
5. Skipping revision: read once, forget in a month

90-DAY STREAK TRACKER

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60
61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79	80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90

Shade a box on every day you did your study block **and** read the newspaper. Missed a day? Don't break twice in a row.

From the video "How to Start UPSC Preparation: Your First 90 Days Plan". A mentor's plan, not official guidance. Syllabus: upsc.gov.in

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